

Strategic Interpretation — Pair 0063 · Semantic Content

Metadata

Semantic Pair ID: gibson_sp063
Source Battery: semantic_content
Model: gpt-oss:20b
Processing Time: 10.70s

Turn Pair (Reference)

Question (MS. EASTERLING):

And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident? (MR. GRINNAN objection: object to the form, foundation.)

Answer (BENJAMIN GIBSON):

I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case. I think it was noting that Energy Transfer was not involved in that work. They hired that contractor. They -- this guy was the foreman and had chose the means and method, that was more the theme in that case for -- given the nuances of that specific matter.

Strategic Signature

Deflection Advantage

Client Value: 2/10 · **Opposition Value:** 8/10

Summary

The witness was asked whether his prior opinions blamed the plaintiff. He answered by shifting the focus to Energy Transfer and contractor details, effectively denying any blame on the plaintiff. This 'blame deflection' is a win for the defense because it removes a key point the plaintiff could use to argue the defendants' negligence. The defense should use this exchange to counter any future claims that the expert blamed the plaintiff and to reinforce that the defendants followed safety protocols.

Use This

[HIGH] Call 6 · pattern

Call 6 explicitly labels the exchange as a 'Blame Deflection', showing the expert avoided blaming the plaintiff—exactly the evidence the defense needs.

[MEDIUM] Call 4 · semantic_function

Call 4 shows the question's intent to probe blame and the answer's narrowing away from blame, giving a solid basis to argue the expert's stance.

[MEDIUM] Call 5 · semantic_complexity

Call 5's semantic drift from blaming the plaintiff to Energy Transfer details confirms the deflection and provides context for further questioning.

Watch This

[LOW] Call 5 · semantic_drift

Keep the line of questioning focused on the defendants; the mention of Energy Transfer is irrelevant and can be ignored.

[LOW] Call 4 · direction_of_force

If the expert attempts to re■introduce blame, be ready to pivot back to the proven deflection.

Call Rank

#1 · Call 6 — Pattern summary gives the clearest strategic signal.

#2 · Call 4 — Shows intent and resolution of the exchange.

#3 · Call 5 — Highlights the shift away from blame.

#4 · Call 1 — Confirms stable topic but less actionable.

#5 · Call 2 — Reaffirms case reference but minimal strategic value.

#6 · Call 3 — Domain classification is background.